

Chapter-9 The Princess

1. “I, Patty Jean Piper, call her the Princess. It’s the perfect name for her.”

a. Who was ‘the Princess’?

The Princess was Patty Jean’s older sister, Penelope Piper, whom everyone called Penny.

b. Why did the narrator call that person ‘the Princess’?

Patty Jean called her sister “the Princess” because Penny sat on her wheelchair (which Patty thought looked like a throne) and seemed to get special treatment from everyone.

c. Do you think the narrator was aware of the problems the Princess had to deal with? Give reasons for your answer.

No, Patty Jean was not aware of the problems Penny faced.

She only noticed the privileges—like being wheeled around, going to a nearby school, and not wearing a uniform—but didn’t realize how difficult life in a wheelchair could be until she tried it herself.

d. Do you agree with Patty Jean that ‘the Princess’ was a good name for Penny? Give reasons for your answer.

No, it was not a good name because it showed misunderstanding.

Penny was not living a life of luxury; she faced challenges due to her disability. Patty only realized later that Penny’s “throne” (wheelchair) was not a symbol of power, but a necessity that helped her move around.

2. “How can you smile all the time when you’re in that yucky chair?”

a. What had happened that had made the narrator call the chair ‘yucky’?

Patty Jean had tried using Penny’s wheelchair, and she fell, got hurt, was laughed at, got caught in the rain, and struggled in the mud. Because of these unpleasant experiences, she called it “yucky.”

b. Do you think the narrator’s feelings towards her sister changed after what she experienced in that ‘yucky chair’? Explain your answer.

Yes, Patty Jean’s feelings changed completely.

She realized how difficult Penny’s life was and felt sorry for misunderstanding her earlier. She grew to respect her sister’s courage and positive attitude.

c. What does this line tell us about Penny's character?

This line shows that Penny is cheerful, brave, and optimistic.

Even though she is confined to a wheelchair, she focuses on what she *can* do instead of what she can't. Her ability to smile despite challenges shows strength and kindness.

Read, reflect and write

1. Why had Patty Jean not gone to camp like all her other friends?

Patty Jean had not gone to camp because her parents didn't have enough money to send her that year.

Her mother explained that the family's money had been spent on new braces for Penny's legs, which were necessary to help Penny walk better.

2. Why do you think the grown-ups turned away when they looked at Patty Jean?

The grown-ups turned away when they looked at Patty Jean because they thought she was a disabled child sitting in a wheelchair.

They probably didn't know what to say or how to react, so they looked away out of pity or discomfort, which made Patty realize how people must sometimes react to her sister, Penny.

3. What did Patty Jean think when she first saw her parents outside the house? Do you think she expected them to be angry? Explain your answer.

When Patty Jean first saw her parents outside the house, she thought they were worried about the wheelchair and that they would be angry with her for taking and damaging it.

But they were not angry at all—they were just relieved and happy that she was safe.

This showed Patty that her parents cared much more about her than about the wheelchair, and it helped her understand their love and concern better.

5 MCQs

1. Why did Patty Jean call her sister 'the Princess'?

- a) Because Penny was very bossy and ordered everyone around
- b) Because Penny had a beautiful crown
- c) Because Penny's wheelchair looked like a throne and she got special attention
- d) Because Penny went to a royal school

Answer: ☒ c) Because Penny's wheelchair looked like a throne and she got special attention

2. Why couldn't Patty Jean go to camp that summer?

- a) She was sick
- b) She had too much homework
- c) The weather was bad
- d) Her parents had spent money on Penny's leg braces

Answer: ☒ d) Her parents had spent money on Penny's leg braces

3. What happened when Patty Jean tried to ride the wheelchair down the hill?

- a) She rode smoothly to the bottom
- b) The wheelchair toppled and she fell down
- c) She met her friends on the way
- d) She reached home quickly

Answer: ☒ b) The wheelchair toppled and she fell down

4. How did Patty Jean feel after experiencing life in the wheelchair?

- a) Angry and jealous
- b) Proud and excited
- c) Sorry and understanding towards her sister
- d) Confused and careless

Answer: ☒ c) Sorry and understanding towards her sister

5. What does Penny's attitude in the story show about her character?

- a) She is lazy and careless
- b) She is cheerful, brave, and positive despite her challenges
- c) She is rude and selfish
- d) She is quiet and shy

Answer: ☒ b) She is cheerful, brave, and positive despite her challenges